

Green Environmental Compliance Violation

The Environmental Protection Agency brings this enforcement action against defendant GreenTech Manufacturing for violations of the Clean Water Act. The defendant operates a chemical manufacturing facility that discharges wastewater into the municipal treatment system under a permit issued pursuant to the National Pollutant Discharge Elimination System. The EPA alleges the defendant exceeded permitted discharge limits for heavy metals and toxic chemicals on multiple occasions between January 2021 and June 2022. The violations were discovered through routine monitoring and inspection. The EPA seeks civil penalties, injunctive relief requiring compliance, and implementation of enhanced monitoring and treatment systems. The defendant acknowledges the violations but asserts they were due to equipment malfunction and were promptly corrected upon discovery. The defendant has since invested in upgraded treatment equipment and enhanced monitoring systems. The defendant requests reduced penalties based on good faith efforts to achieve compliance. The court finds the defendant liable for the violations but recognizes the defendant's cooperation and remedial measures. The court imposes civil penalties of \$250,000, requires continued compliance monitoring for three years, and orders implementation of the enhanced treatment systems. The defendant shall submit quarterly compliance reports to the EPA.